

How to Update the TruCheck FAQ

Process for replacing FAQ content and rebuilding the chatbot's knowledge base

Overview

The chatbot doesn't edit its own knowledge - it re-reads whatever files are sitting in the data/ folder whenever the ingestion script is run. That means updating the FAQ is really just: swap the file, then re-run one script. The system doesn't care whether a file is the same document edited in place or a brand new file with different content - either way, a rebuild picks up exactly what's currently in that folder.

Steps

Step 1 Remove the old FAQ file

Delete the current file from the data folder:

```
rm ~/trucheck-chatbot/data/TruCheck_Internal_FAQ.pdf
```

Step 2 Add the new or modified FAQ file

Copy the updated file into that same folder. It can keep the same filename or use a new one - the ingestion script picks up any .pdf or .docx file it finds there automatically.

```
cp ~/path/to/your/new_faq_file.pdf ~/trucheck-chatbot/data/
```

Step 3 Confirm the folder only has what you expect

Check that the old file is really gone and the new one is present:

```
ls -la ~/trucheck-chatbot/data/
```

Step 4 Preview the chunking (optional, recommended for new content)

This prints how the document will be split into Q&A pieces, without touching the database yet. Worth doing whenever the content includes a table, since tables are the trickiest part to extract cleanly.

```
cd ~/trucheck-chatbot/ingestion
python chunk.py ../data/your_new_faq_file.pdf
```

Skim the output - confirm each question and answer split looks correct and nothing reads as jumbled or merged incorrectly.

Step 5 Rebuild the knowledge base

This is the step that actually makes the change take effect. It performs a full rebuild: whatever is currently in data/ becomes the entire knowledge base, replacing what was there before.

```
python embed_and_store.py --docs-dir ../data --collection trucheck_faq
```

Expect output ending in a line like "Done. Collection 'trucheck_faq' now has N entries." The number of entries will change if content was added or removed.

Step 6 Test the update

Ask about the specific content that changed, and confirm the correct - and updated - chunk comes back as the top match:

```
python query_test.py "ask about whatever changed"
```

Step 7 No restart needed

The backend server and the chat widget do not need to be restarted or redeployed. The backend reads from the database fresh on every question, so the update is live in the chatbot immediately after Step 5 completes.

Notes

- A rebuild is always a full replace, not an incremental patch - deleting a file from data/ before rebuilding means its content is fully removed from what the chatbot knows.
- Multiple FAQ files can live in data/ at once - the ingestion script processes every .pdf and .docx file it finds there in a single run.
- If a table's rows look garbled in the Step 4 preview, that's worth fixing before rebuilding - it usually means the row labels didn't extract cleanly and may need a small adjustment to the table-handling logic in chunk.py.